"Share your resources and wisdom to be happy"

By **BABA RAMDEV**



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HAPPINESS MANTRA

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Happiness is the expression of a completely satisfied life. When an individual feels satisfaction in all aspects of life—personal, family, social, financial, professional—then he or she can feel happiness. One may find temporary happiness in materialistic things such as power, wealth, fame and reward but they cannot be the source of eternal and sustainable happiness. One can be happy even without acquiring any of these. Such physical attributes are important for living a comfortable life but are not the ingredients of happiness. For instance, if a person is not healthy, he or she certainly cannot be happy no matter how socially successful he or she is. At the same time, good health doesn't automatically guarantee happiness.

Happiness is not about achieving something or gaining success. It's about sharing your resources and wisdom. You don't earn happiness. You live happy when your existence makes a positive impact on someone else's life. If personal achievement becomes the barometer of happiness, the moment of achievement is the end of that source of happiness and a new form of unhappiness or sense of deprivation begins. Many also get afflicted by the fear of losing what they have achieved. What we don't achieve is more and what we get is always less. Nobody gets more and nobody remains happy in less. The trick of being happy is being content in less and utilising this "less" in the larger interest of mankind and nature.

Happiness also comes from respecting, enjoying and performing with integrity one's professional commitments. An individual must strive for excellence in whatever task he or she sets out to accomplish. Many tend to be overly critical of their professional hazards, but efficiency, commitment and a sense of integrity make the same job a source of internal happiness. Whatever an individual does in life, he or she must start loving their work. People waste a lot of time in competition with others. The objective rather should be striving for excellence in self and discipline in desires.

As human beings, we must follow the laws of nature and the Almighty, the rules of the country we live in and the moral and ethical norms of our society. One who follows all three will always be happy. It's very important for us to surrender to the will of the Almighty. It makes one realise that inclusive, integrated and eternal happiness can be derived from power rooted in service, progress rooted in a noble goal, work rooted in a prayer, valour rooted in humility and revolution rooted in peace.

For any individual looking for happiness in daily life, I suggest they follow these principles:

- Live a moral, disciplined, and scientific life
- Share what you have. Start with feeding an animal, helping a poor person or educating an illiterate one.
- Internalise the truth that you are a unique creation of God. You have all the abilities of the most successful person on earth built into you. You can do wonders too.
- Feel grateful to God
- Stay indifferent to negative elements or happenings in the society and seek inspiration from positive developments. ■

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